work for the poor of this parish of St. Margaret's Westminster, as also the county according to law, and for such as will beg and live idle in this city and liberty of Westminster. Anno 1655."

This prison has—for men, two day-rooms and three night-rooms—for faulty apprentices, five rooms, ten feet by seven feet two inches; the upper and lower panels of the doors are iron-latticed. For women, a day-room, and four night-rooms. All the night-rooms have barrack beds. They are constantly washed every day; and are quite fresh. The prisoners wash their hands and faces every morning before they come for their allowance. No straw. No infirmary. A little room used as a surgery. A chapel, in which Mr. Smith reads a chapter, and part of the Common Prayer Book every morning.

The women should have another day-room: and one of the day-rooms for men should be enlarged. The courts adjacent might also be enlarged. The rooms for women, and their court, are now more airy, the garden pales being set farther off. The keeper pays window-tax, and for water. Over the gate is a paper with this inscription: "No person admitted into this prison on a Sunday after nine o'clock in the morning until five in the evening."

At my visit in 1777, there were among the felons, two debtors from the Court of Conscience; in 1779, three; and in 1783, six. I always found this prison very clean: and the prisoners calm and placid. There is now a workshop with hemp-blocks, and a room over it. Two of the women's night-rooms are appropriated to female convicts, who have also a separate court with water, etc. As I have seen several sick objects on the floors, the gentlemen, who are so ready to relieve the sufferings of their fellow-creatures, will forgive the intimation that an infirmary might be made over the women's ward.

THE KING'S BENCH PRISON, FOR DEBTORS

Number:

	In House	In Rules		In House	In Rules
1774. 26 April	324	100	1779. 26 Oct.	438	60
1776. 28 Jan.	364	80	1782. 2 Jan.	450	7
1776. 28 May	395 (*See* remarks.)		1782. 28 Dec.	485	30
1779. 11 Aug.	511	75	1783. 23 Aug.	532	50

This prison was part old buildings, part new.

The old buildings were—a coffee-room just within the gate—and a street called King Street. On the right hand was the

tap-house; and four houses for prisoners: each consisted of a ground-floor, and two floors of chambers; four rooms on each floor; near ten feet square, and seven high. On the left-hand side of the street was the chapel; and six houses for prisoners; of equal depth with the former houses: but the back-rooms had not, as the former had, communication with the fore-rooms. At the hither end of the fore-rooms, on the ground-floor, was a common kitchen, much too small. The cook, a prisoner, had the room over it. These houses also had ground-rooms, and two floors of chambers. All the rooms fronting King Street, and the whole of the houses on the other side the way, were for master's-side debtors; who paid for each room unfurnished a shilling a week. The back part of the left-hand row was the common-side; the doors in the back-front. The first room on the ground-floor they called their court-room. The two houses at the farther end had six rooms each, for Crown debtors and fines; and were called Crown Court. The rest of this range on all the three floors was for common-side debtors. At the farther end of King Street, in a small court enclosed from the rest of the yard, was a building called the State House; consisting of ground-floors, and two floors of chambers; four sizable rooms on each floor; total twelve. A debtor who chose to be here, paid the marshal from eight to ten guineas for his whole time; besides a shilling a week, like other master's-side debtors.

All these old buildings were out of repair.

The new buildings were—first, a house at the gate for the turnkey. The chambers were very convenient; and were let to a prisoner who paid a very high rent. But the principal new building was at the farther end of the yard. The two parts of it formed a right-angle. One part was four houses, with four ground-rooms to each; and the same number of chambers on each of the three floors above: total sixty-four. The rooms were about thirteen feet by eleven, and about eight feet high. The other part (the wing) was built as the Fleet Prison; but more airy and commodious. It had the same number of floors as the first part. On each floor was a passage seven and a half feet wide, and seventy-three and a half feet long: rooms on each side the passage, eleven on each floor, total forty-four; each room thirteen and a half feet by nine and a half, about eight feet high.

The prison is well supplied with water. Among the improvements, of a hundred and eight new rooms, and a spacious court, they should have built an infirmary. At more than one of my